DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH &. HUMAN SERVICES

Public Health Service

Indian Health Service
Phoenix Indian Medical Center
4212 North 16th Street
Phoenix, Arizona 85016

MEMORANDUM FOR RECORD

To: Adrienne Frazier, Laboratory Manager
Cc: Suzanne Belzer, Acting Chief of Pathology
Cc: Charisse Holiday, Chief Professional Officer
From: Hon. Kevin D. Turnage, MSN, RN, NHDP-BC, NPD-BC, AMB-BC, NE-BC
Policy and Procedure Officer, Nurse Consultant
Date: May 23, 2025
Subject: Rejection of Policy – RPMS, EHR, and Other Laboratory Software Updates and Installation (PolicyStat ID: 18164480)

Dear Ms. Frazier,

After review of the above-referenced policy, it is **not approved** at this time due to noncompliance with the current **Phoenix Service Unit (PSU) Policy Management policy (PolicyStat ID: 16791609).**

Reasons for Rejection

1. Outdated Reference Materials

- The policy cites a **1994 version** of the VA Laboratory User Manual. This source has been superseded by multiple updates, most recently in **September 2020**.
- As required by PSU Policy Management **Section F.1.e**, current federal, accreditation, and clinical references must be included.

2. Missing Federal and Technical Standards

- The policy does not cite the **HIPAA Security Rule** (45 CFR §164.308, §164.312), **NIST 800-53** controls, or relevant **Indian Health Manual (IHM)** guidance for information systems security and software governance.

3. Lack of Continuous Review and Monitoring

- PSU **Section F.1.m** requires continuous policy review aligned with changes in regulations or systems. This policy does not describe a review cycle or responsible parties for ongoing compliance monitoring.

4. Insufficient Integration of Operational Forms into Policy Workflow

- While Forms LIS.F.04-01 and LIS.F.02-01 are valid operational tools (e.g., for checklist or validation use), the policy does not describe how these forms are triggered, who completes them, how they are stored, or how their use is audited.
- As per PSU Sections F.1.a and F.1.b, such tools must be referenced clearly in the policy body to ensure reliable outcomes, reduce variation, and support implementation.

Required Revisions

- Update the **Reference section** to reflect current federal regulations, guidance, and technical standards.
- Clearly **describe the operational use of attached forms** within the policy text (e.g., responsible roles, timing, retention, audit).
- Establish a **defined monitoring and review process** for continuous software compliance and validation.
- Align update and installation procedures with **HIPAA, NIST**, and **IHS OIT** technical safeguard standards.

Policy Officer Disclaimer

This review was conducted in accordance with responsibilities outlined in the PSU Policy Management policy. While I provide compliance review and technical support, **final accountability for content accuracy, regulatory alignment, and implementation rests with the document owner and relevant service leadership.**

Although this policy was previously approved under earlier policy management criteria, the May 2025 review was conducted under the current PSU Policy Management policy (PolicyStat ID: 16791609). Revised standards now require that all policies—whether new or undergoing revision—fully meet the updated criteria, including embedded references, training documentation, compliance monitoring, and clearly integrated tools or forms. This ensures consistency with evolving regulatory, accreditation, and operational expectations.

Attachments and supplemental documents are not considered compliant substitutes for required policy content as defined in PSU Policy Management. **All essential information must be embedded within the body of the policy** to ensure clarity, traceability, and audit readiness.

Digitally signed by Kevin D. Turnage -S
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